



MICRO-SAAS MARKET INTELLIGENCE

The Long Tail Economy

Power-Law Dynamics, Segment Economics & M&A Arbitrage Across 8,782 Bootstrapped Businesses

Prepared for Executive & Investment Committee Review

Source: TrustMRR Full Dataset • Frozen 30 July 2026 • 8,782 records

A Fragmented Market Where a Small Elite Captures Almost Everything

42.8%

of listed startups
generate any revenue

3,757 of 8,782 records

57.8%

of all active MRR sits
with the top 1% of firms

37 startups out of 3,757

0.0%

median 30-day MRR
growth rate

43% are flat or shrinking

3.0x

median revenue multiple
for businesses on sale

995 revenue-generating listings

1

Extreme concentration

The top 10% of revenue-generating startups (375 firms) capture 90% of all Monthly Recurring Revenue. This is a power-law market, not a normal distribution — median outcomes are close to irrelevant for strategy.

3

B2B out-earns B2C on every dimension

B2B startups post 2.1x the median MRR of B2C peers and monetize traffic 2.6x more efficiently per visitor, despite 43% fewer listings — a supply/demand imbalance worth exploiting.

2

Growth has stalled for the majority

42.9% of active businesses show exactly 0% MRR growth and 28.6% are shrinking. Only 1 in 5 is growing faster than 10% a month. Most listed assets are cash-flow plays, not growth bets.

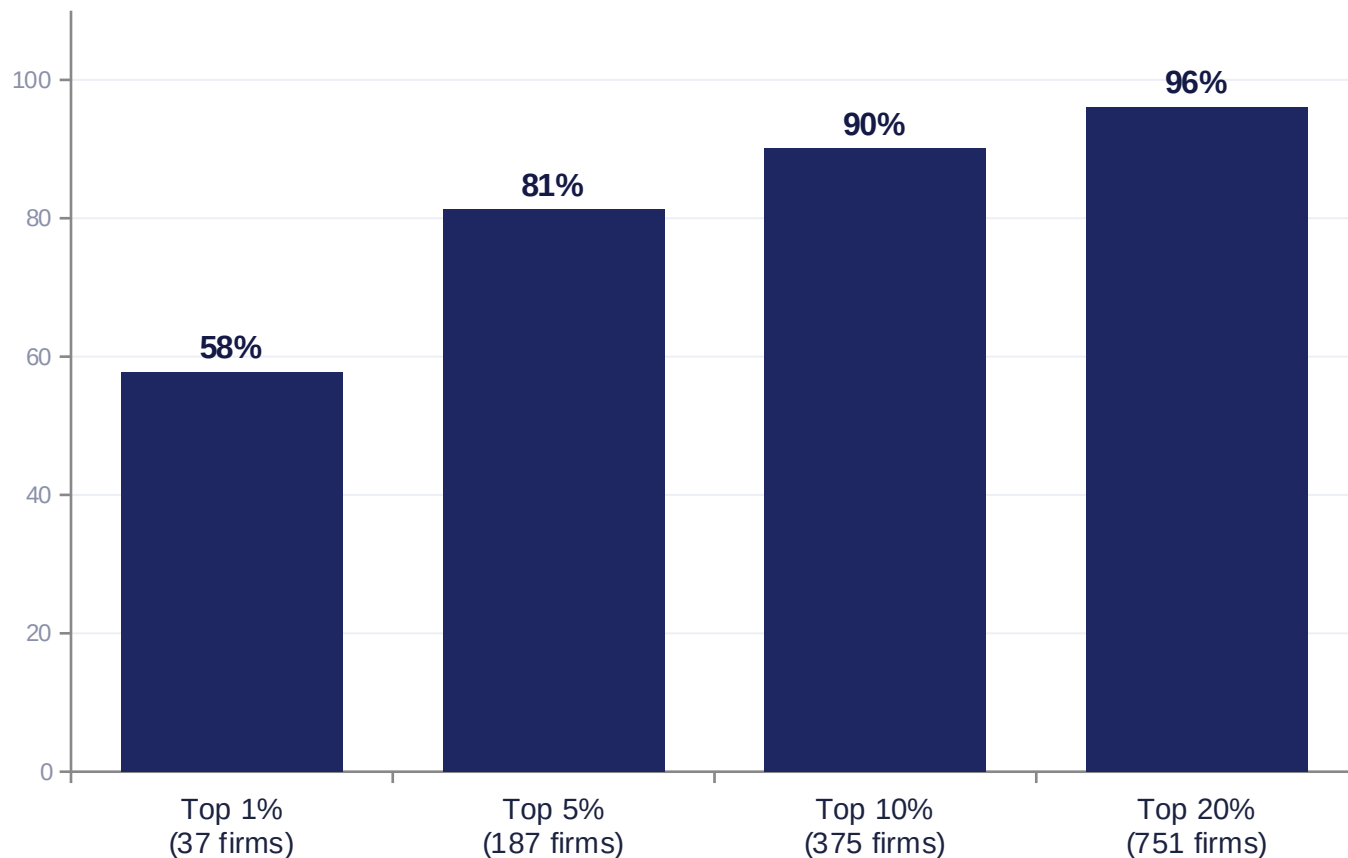
4

The market already misprices growth

Businesses growing 10–30%/month command the highest multiples (3.5x); ironically, hyper-growth (>30%) trades at a discount (2.6x) as buyers price in volatility — creating a clear acquisition window.

A Power-Law Market: Value Concentrates in a Tiny Elite

Cumulative share of total active MRR (\$15.4M) captured by top-performing startups



WHAT THIS MEANS

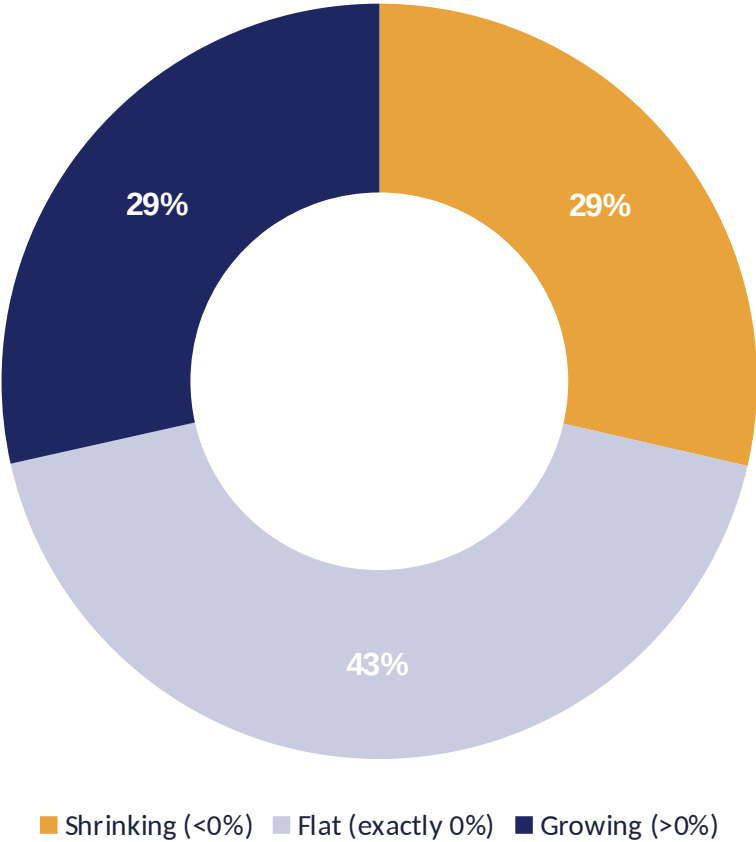
This is not a bell curve. 37 startups — four-tenths of one percent of the platform — generate more revenue than the other 8,745 combined.

Implication for buyers: index-fund thinking (broad, diversified acquisition) does not work here. Winners must be hand-picked; the median asset is a lifestyle business, not a platform.

Implication for founders: category leadership compounds — being #1 in a niche is worth more than being broadly present.

Most of the Market Has Plateaued

Distribution of 30-day MRR growth across 3,757 revenue-generating startups



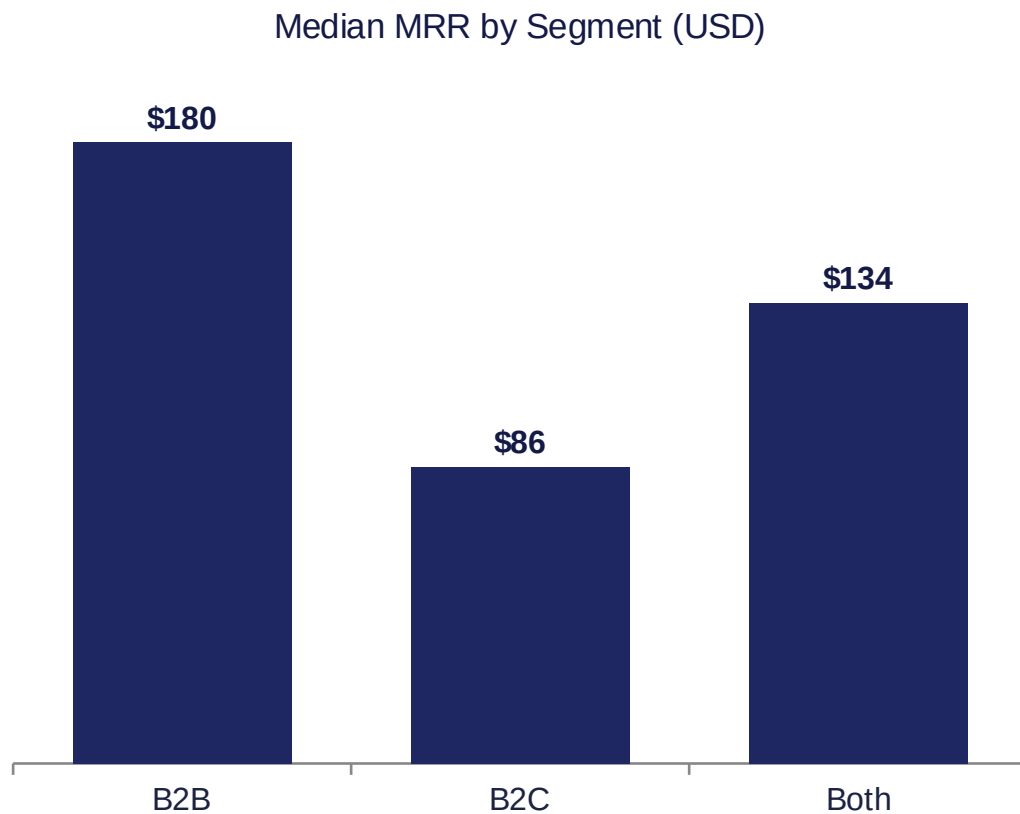
A closer look at the 28.5% that ARE growing



Bottom line: growth-chasing strategies must be highly selective — nearly three-quarters of the market is not compounding.

B2B Commands a Structural Economic Advantage

Comparing 1,042 B2B vs. 1,820 B2C revenue-generating startups



2.1x

Higher median MRR for B2B vs. B2C (\$180 vs. \$86)

2.6x

More revenue captured per website visitor: \$0.52 (B2B) vs. \$0.20 (B2C)

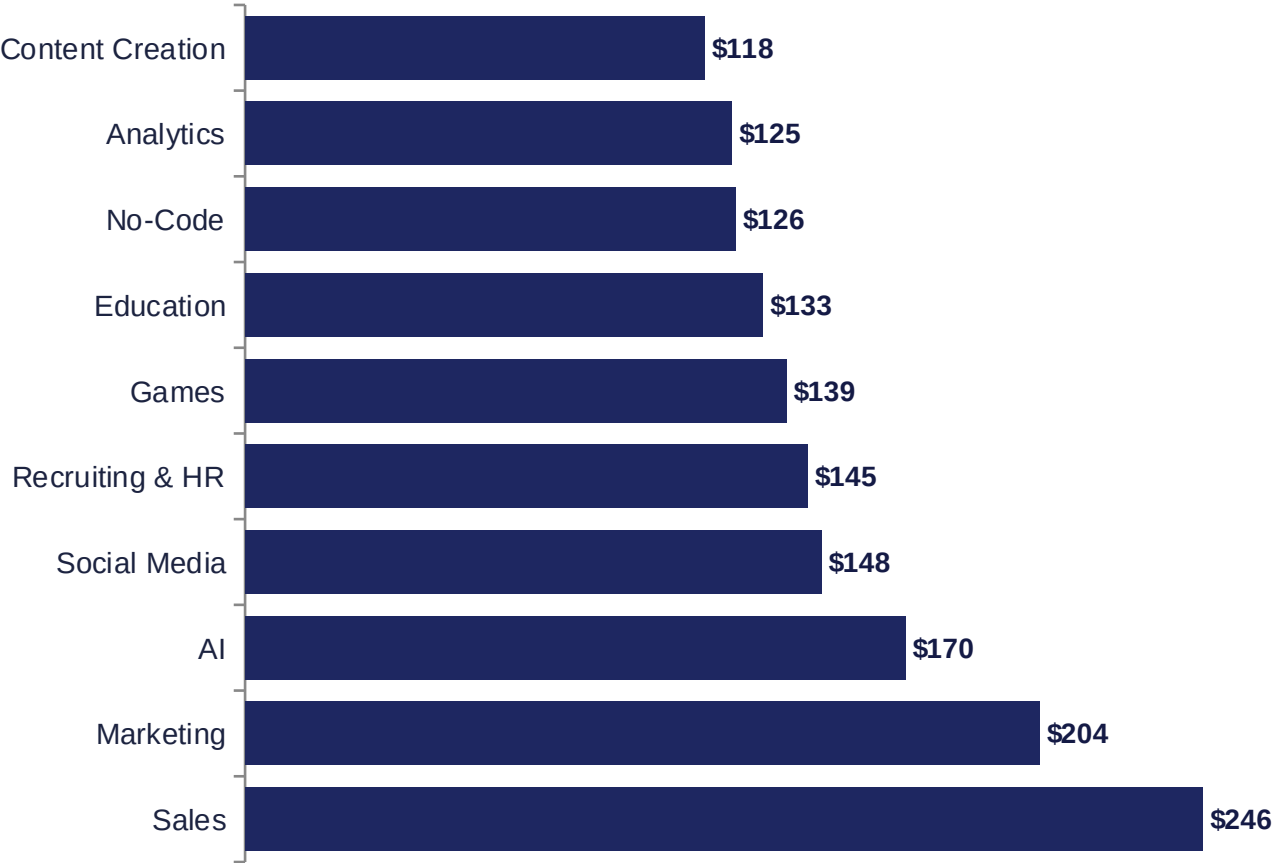
3.1x vs 2.9x

B2B also commands a modestly higher resale multiple

Read: B2C wins on volume (1,820 vs. 1,042 listings) but loses badly on unit economics. For acquirers prioritizing cash-on-cash return, B2B is the stronger hunting ground per dollar deployed.

Hype and Profitability Are Not the Same Thing

Median MRR by category (categories with 20+ revenue-generating listings)



⚠ THE AI OVERSUPPLY SIGNAL

AI is the single most crowded category — 824 active listings, more than 3x the next-largest category — yet ranks only 3rd on median MRR (\$169.50).

30.5% of AI startups are listed for sale — the highest exit rate of any major category, a classic signal of founder fatigue in an oversaturated field.

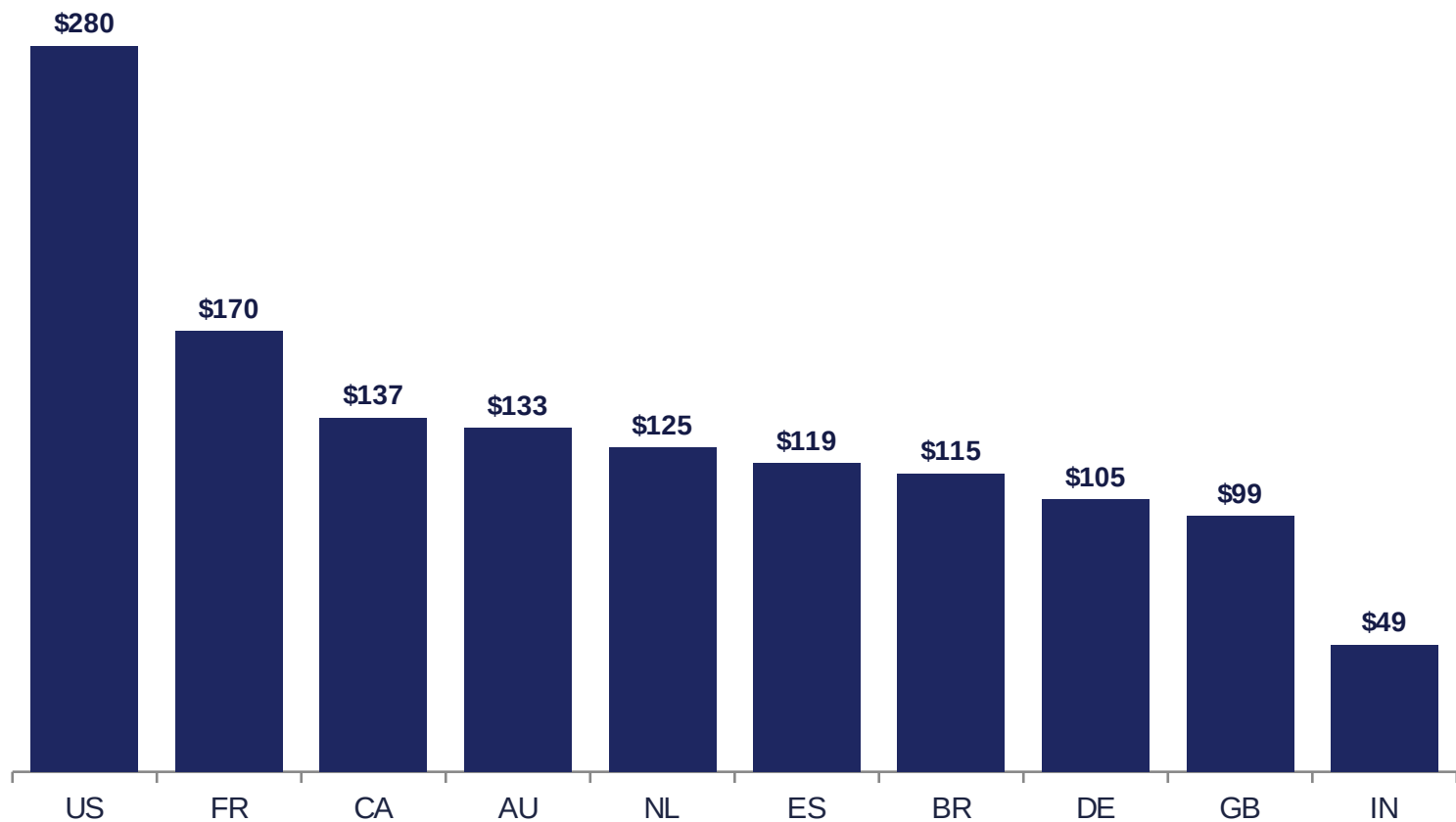
✓ UNDERCOVERED POCKETS OF VALUE

Sales tooling leads on median MRR (\$246) and commands the richest resale multiple (5.05x) with only 33 active competitors — the best risk-adjusted category in the dataset.

Fintech and Design Tools also command 5.0x multiples despite modest revenue — the market is pricing in defensibility, not just current cash flow.

The U.S. Commands a Structural Pricing Premium

Median MRR by country (top 10 markets by number of revenue-generating listings)



KEY READS

- The US leads on both volume (879 listings) and price — its median MRR of \$280 is 5.7x India's \$49.
- France is a surprising #2 by ARPU (\$170) with meaningful scale (270 listings) — an underexplored sourcing market for acquirers.
- India offers volume and low entry price but the weakest monetization per business — better suited to portfolio roll-ups than single-asset bets.

The Market Misprices Growth — Creating an Acquisition Window

995

revenue-generating startups
currently listed for sale

26.5%

of all active businesses
are on the market

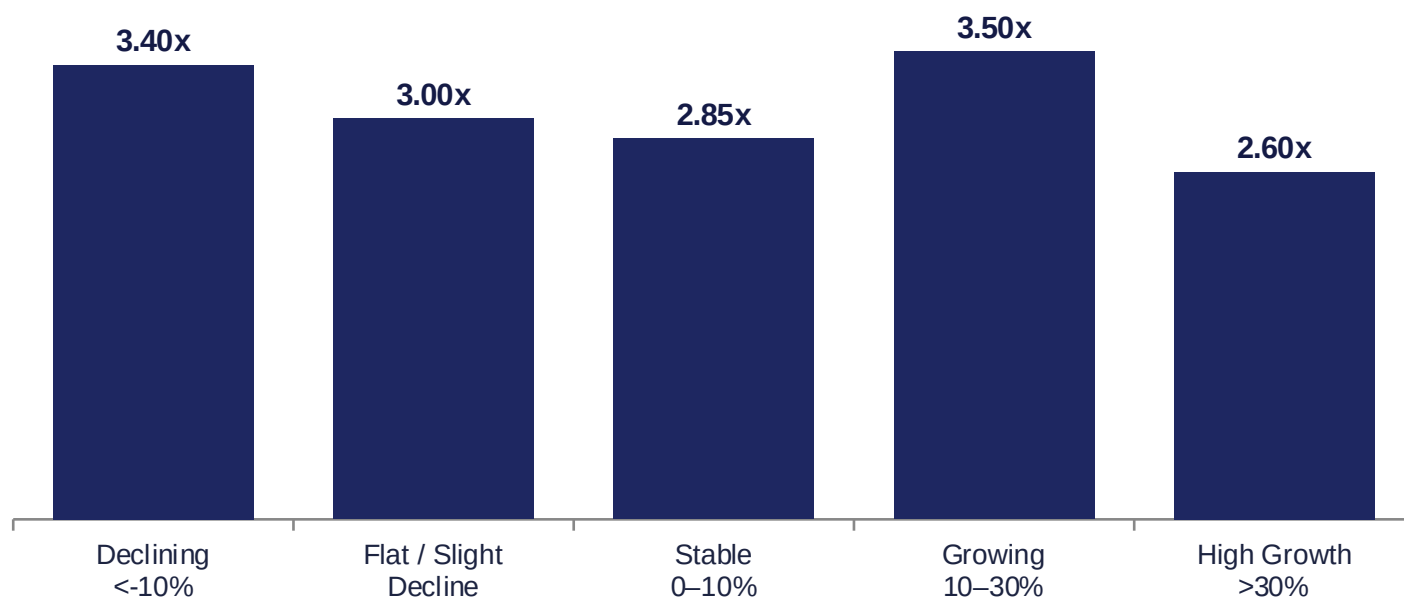
\$12,000

median asking price
(revenue-generating assets)

3.0x

median revenue multiple
across all live listings

Median resale multiple by 30-day growth trajectory



THE ARBITRAGE

Steady 10–30%/month growers command the richest multiples (3.50x) — buyers pay up for proven, sustainable momentum.

Counter-intuitively, hyper-growth (>30%/month) trades at a discount (2.60x) — the market discounts volatility and unproven durability.

Sophisticated buyers should target hyper-growth assets before the market re-rates them upward.

38 Undervalued Acquisition Candidates Identified

Screen: positive growth (>5%/mo), multiple below market median (<3.0x), MRR > \$500 — top candidates by MRR shown below

Startup	Category	MRR (USD)	30d Growth	Multiple	Asking Price
Backlinker AI	Marketing	\$26,950	+5.3%	1.3x	\$350,000
Groups Watcher	Marketing	\$21,423	+19.7%	2.2x	\$500,000
SetSmart	SaaS	\$15,659	+100.0%	0.8x	\$499,000
Linkar	Unclassified	\$14,259	+5.7%	2.8x	\$200,000
Kickly – Pronos IA	Games	\$10,236	+384.5%	0.7x	\$100,000
Tactical Football Analysis	News & Magazines	\$9,229	+23.4%	2.8x	\$199,999
NextjobConnect LLC	SaaS	\$7,534	+23.7%	1.2x	\$100,000
FeedGuardians	Social Media	\$7,507	+10.0%	2.9x	\$300,000

HOW TO READ THIS

Each candidate is growing revenue while priced below the market's own 3.0x median — either mispriced by an unsophisticated seller, or a red flag warranting deeper diligence on churn and revenue quality.

Recommended next step: commission quality-of-earnings review on the top 5 before offer.

Four Moves for the Executive Committee

1 Hunt selectively, not broadly

With 90% of value in the top 10% of assets, deploy diligence resources against a short list of category leaders rather than portfolio-style bulk acquisition.

2 Overweight B2B, underweight generic B2C

B2B delivers 2.1x the MRR and 2.6x the traffic monetization of B2C. Redirect sourcing effort accordingly, especially in Sales, Marketing, and Recruiting & HR tooling.

3 Avoid the AI crowding trade

824 competing listings and a 30.5% exit rate signal an oversupplied category. Deploy capital in adjacent, underserved niches (Sales, Fintech, Design Tools) with stronger multiples and less competition.

4 Buy hyper-growth before the market re-rates it

High-growth assets (>30%/month) trade at a 25% discount to steady 10–30% growers. This mispricing window should close as more buyers recognize the pattern — move now.

Methodology & Data Notes

Dataset	TrustMRR Full Dataset, frozen 30 July 2026. 8,782 startup records across 29 fields including MRR, growth, category, geography, and sale status.
Filters applied	"Revenue-generating" = <code>mrr_usd > 0</code> (n = 3,757). Category and country cuts additionally require count > 20 listings to avoid small-sample noise.
Revenue multiple	Parsed from the platform's listed "revenue_multiple" field (e.g., "2.1x" → 2.1); reflects asking-price-to-annualized-revenue ratio as listed by sellers, not closed transaction data.
Limitations	Figures reflect self-reported, platform-listed data at a single point in time; asking prices are not verified closed sale prices. ~57% of records report zero or unreported MRR and are excluded from revenue-based cuts. Category/audience fields are missing for some of the highest-MRR outliers (e.g., "Stan"), which are noted but not force-classified.
Undervalued screen (Slide 9)	Growth > 5%/month AND multiple < 3.0x (sample median) AND MRR > \$500, restricted to active for-sale listings (n = 995 eligible, 38 matched).